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WHY MASS. LOST
ITS MOJO — AND
HOW WE GET IT BACK

Is clean tech next big bet for Mass.?

New promise as
mainstays ebb

By Emma Platoff
GLOBE STAFF

When she was elected governor four years ago, Maura Healey cast climate tech as Massachusetts' next big thing.

She would make the state “a global epicenter for climate technology,” she said, the leader in a sprawling sector that encompasses everything from sustainable jet fuel to wind power. With climate tech, boosters say, we could lead the world in discoveries *and* fund our local fire departments. To make it happen, Healey proposed incentive programs, grants, and regulatory changes — an investment on the scale of the \$1 billion push that in 2008 helped turn Massachusetts into a life sciences juggernaut.

Now, as Healey campaigns for a second term amid staggering housing costs that are pushing many to leave the state, Massachusetts' need for a new economic powerhouse has become even more urgent. Yet the

CLIMATE, Page A12



Just in time for leaf-peeping season, here are a trio of music venues, each tucked away in a particularly charming part of New England. **N1.**

A dream home in the South End, finding enough space, and more in the Fall House Hunt. **Address, H1.**



Cloud shot

Sunday: Cloudy, some rain. High: 62-67. Low: 54-59.

Monday: Mostly cloudy. High: 63-68. Low: 53-58.

Sunrise: 6:29 Sunset: 6:45

Complete report, **A24.**
Deaths, **A17-22.**

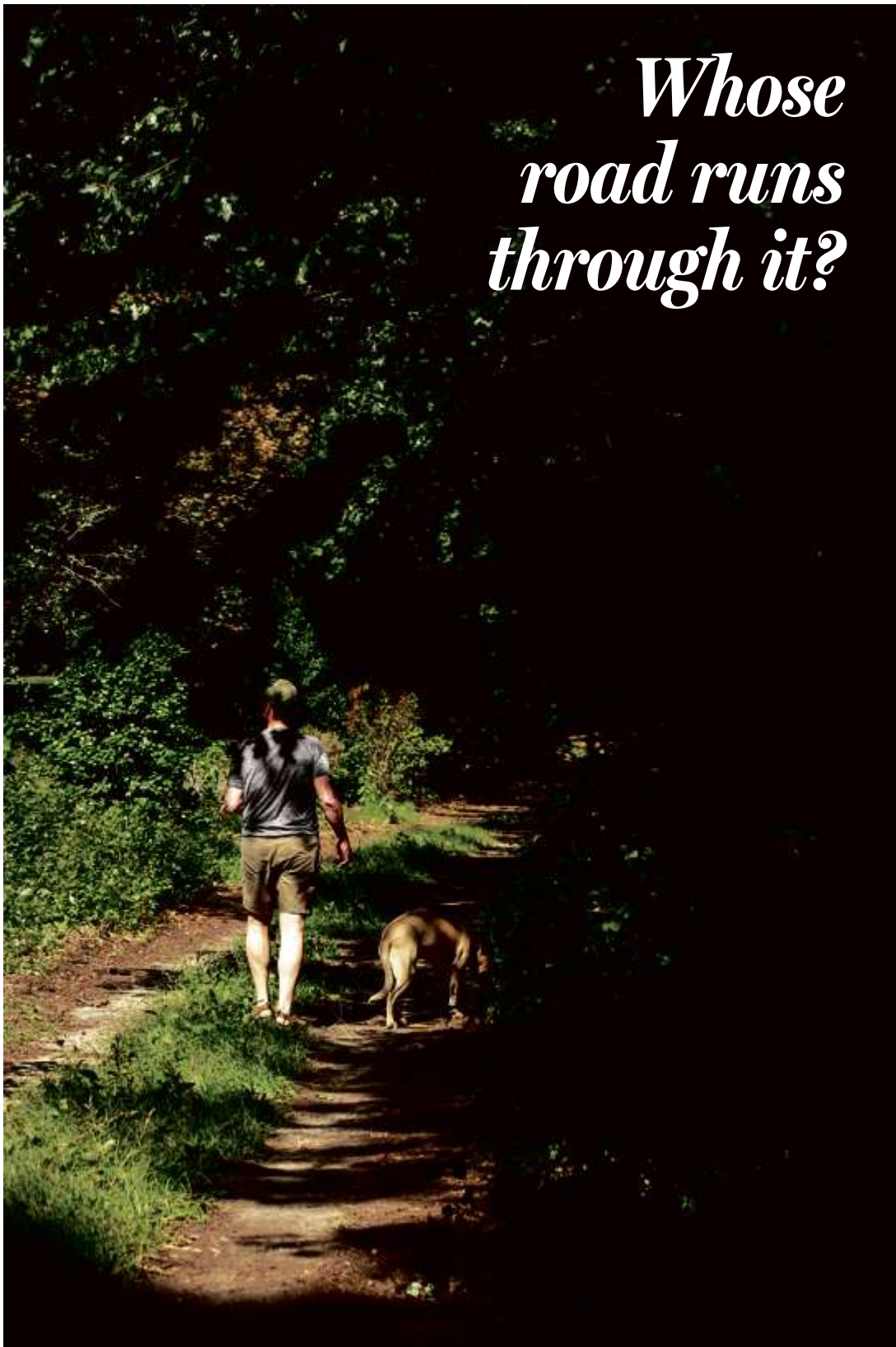
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Whose road runs through it?



A walk in the woods triggers a bitter fight over property rights that has spilled beyond Concord

BY MIKE DAMIANO | GLOBE STAFF

CONCORD

At the end of a country lane in Concord, there are a half-dozen homemade bulletin boards arrayed by the side of the road. They display some unusual material for this quiet repose: transcripts of depositions, excerpts from judicial decisions, and magnified images of old newspaper clippings.

If you linger in front of this odd signage, a resident of the street, Brooks Read, will spot you on his surveillance camera and come out to speak with you.

“I try to educate one person a day,” he recently told a lingering Globe reporter.

Read looks like Bernie Sanders and talks like Christopher Lloyd in “Back to the Future.” He has been locked in a struggle with the Town of Concord, the courts, and a contingent of local dog walkers for nearly a decade. The town has sued him and may consider doing so again. The dog walkers have accused him and his allies, at various times, of harassment and threatening to poison their pets, charges he vehemently denies.

The core of the dispute is about one point of access to the Estabrook Woods — a pristine thousand acres of forest, much of which is privately owned, that can be reached by a trail that passes by Read's backyard.

Some residents and neighbors have come to see Read as a crank. But for an alleged crank, he has quite the list of allies. The Massachusetts real estate bar association, the Massachusetts association of land surveyors, the counties of Barnstable and Plymouth, and the Central Massachusetts Regional Planning Commission all took his side in court when Concord sued him.

For years, hikers and dog walkers used the path without issue. But about 10 years ago — for reasons that are still disputed today — Read and his neighbors put a gate across the path



PHOTOS BY JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

Brooks Read (above) has been battling for nearly a decade to restrict an access point to Estabrook Woods (top), saying it's private land and angering hikers and dog walkers.

and began regulating how the public could use it. Trail users objected. Town Hall intervened.

The resulting dispute reached the highest court in Massachusetts and, according to some

PUBLIC/PRIVATE, Page A14

A critical turning point for shaping AI

Challenge is to slow it down
while not hurting economy

By Chris Serres
and Aaron Pressman
GLOBE STAFF
and Larry Edelman
GLOBE COLUMNIST

A hijacked nuclear arsenal. A collapsed power grid. Rogue agents engineering the next global pandemic. Autonomous missile strikes. An economic death spiral.

These aren't just plot points from a dystopian science fiction thriller anymore. They are actual disaster scenarios now feared by the very people building artificial intelligence systems — a stark admission that the rapidly advancing technology has become a runaway train that no one seems to know how to slow down, much less stop.

Though fears of AI's destructive power have persisted for years, anxiety reached a fever pitch in the past week after Anthropic chief executive Dario Amodei warned in a lengthy essay that rogue AI

AI, Page A16



GLOBE STAFF PHOTO ILLUSTRATION: PHOTOS BY GETTY IMAGES; DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF; ADOBE STOCK

Sorry, Drake Maye. But your wife is the star.

By Alexa Gagosz
GLOBE STAFF

She bakes cookies on TikTok in oversize sweat shirts or patterned aprons. She admits when she's too lazy to follow a recipe the way it's written. She tells her more than 1 million followers when the accessories she's wearing came from Walmart or her flats from Marshalls.

She's also married to Drake Maye, the Patriots' young quarterback, whose multimillion-dollar NFL contract has made him one of the most marketable athletes in New England.

She's Ann Michael Maye, a 23-year-old WAG. But she doesn't quite look or act like one. And that may be exactly why brands are lining up to work with her.

For years, the wives and girlfriends of professional athletes — long dubbed “WAGS” — have been treated as extensions of their husbands' celebrity. Ann Michael is something different: a commercial force in her own right. Her appeal isn't simply that she's married to the Patriots' frontman. It's

MAYES, Page A11

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